



OAS | CICAD

SATA e-Newsletter Vol.29

June, 2026

SATA

The Inter-American Observatory on Drugs (OID), of the Inter-American Drug Abuse Control Commission (CICAD), of the Organization of American States (OAS) manages and coordinates the Early Warning System of the Americas (SATA) within the framework of the Hemispheric Drug Strategy 2020 and its Plan of Action.

The SATA operates as a clearinghouse and dissemination platform for information on emerging drug threats, fueled by alerts issued by national early warning systems (EWS). It also fosters international and horizontal cooperation in drug monitoring and response efforts.

For more information on new and emerging drugs in the Americas, visit: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/security/early-warnings-system>

SATA

Early Warning System of the Americas

Summary of Emerging Drug Alerts and Information in May 2026

1. **ADULTERANTS**
2. **MDMA and THC**
3. **"TUCI"**
4. **TETRAHYDROCANNABIPHOROL (THCP)**
5. **MEDETOMIDINE**
6. **MITRAGYNE DERIVATIVES and KRATOM BYPRODUCTS**
7. **CRYSTAL METH**
8. **MDMA**
9. **TETRAHYDROCANNABIPHOROL (THCP)**

INTER-AMERICAN DRUG ABUSE CONTROL COMMISSION (CICAD)
INTER-AMERICAN OBSERVATORY ON DRUGS (OID)

<https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs>

KEY FINDINGS

Information from National EWS in the Region

The U.S. Early Warning System (NDEWS) emphasized the risk of adulterants in the local drug supply. Key findings include state-based reports identifying 139 deaths in California due to fentanyl, methamphetamine, cocaine, and benzodiazepines. In Nebraska, wastewater data showed increased levels of carfentanil, from February to March 2026, followed by decreases in April and May. Authorities also reported rising naloxone levels in wastewater, which may suggest an increase in overdose response activity.

Ohio reported the emergence of “orphine” analogs, particularly N-propionitrile chlorphine, also known as cychlorphine, which was detected in polysubstance drug samples. Florida reported the continued predominance of cocaine, fentanyl, and methamphetamine, alongside a notable decrease in detections of new psychoactive substances (NPS) and fentanyl analogs.

Nonfatal overdoses associated with veterinary sedatives, including medetomidine, were also reported. These cases raise concern about the ongoing presence of fentanyl, heroin, and veterinary sedatives in the unregulated drug supply. Additionally, the emergence of new mitragynine derivatives and other kratom-related compounds illustrates how minor chemical modifications can generate new psychoactive substances that remain largely unregulated.

Guyana’s Early Warning System (EWS) warned about the rapid circulation of synthetic drugs such as methamphetamine hydrochloride, MDMA, and products containing tetrahydrocannabinol (THCP). THCP is an emerging cannabinoid reportedly possessing significantly greater psychoactive potency than traditional THC, particularly in products reportedly circulating among school-aged children. Authorities also warned that some substances are being misrepresented as “legal,” “natural,” or “wellness” supplements, creating false perceptions of safety among youth. These trends raise concern about the increased use and polysubstance use, particularly given the unknown concentrations, unverified ingredients, the presence of THCP, combinations with psychoactive mushrooms, and adulteration with caffeine, methamphetamine, synthetic cathinones, and other stimulants. Guyana’s reports also alerted to micro-trafficking networks targeting school-aged children and adolescents, particularly through social media and nightlife environments.

Colombia’s EWS reported the unpredictable composition and associated health risks of “tuci.” One sample contained a combination of over nine different substances, including adulterants, underscoring the risks posed by complex drug mixtures. The detection of

synthetic drugs, stimulants, and adulterants previously reported in North America and Guyana raises concerns about broader regional trends in synthetic drug trafficking and use.

Received Alerts and Collected Information

1. United States (May 29, 2026) – Alert on Adulterants

The NDEWS Weekly Report highlighted findings from the April 2026 report of the Sentinel Site Directors (SSDs), which analyzed the prevalence and concentration of adulterants in the local drug supply across 14 NDEWS Sentinel Sites in the U.S. (Western three sites, Midwestern five sites, Southern four sites, Northeastern two sites). Reported trends included pharmacologically active adulterants, local anesthetics (known as “caines”), and non-opioid sedatives such as xylazine, medetomidine, and benzodiazepines.

The report also included regional and site-specific insights. In San Francisco, California, at least one death was linked to a novel synthetic opioid found in counterfeit pills that was not detected by standard fentanyl test strips. From January to April 2026, San Diego County recorded 139 drug-related deaths. Reported substance involvement included fentanyl in 24 deaths, methamphetamine in 33, fentanyl and methamphetamine in 50, cocaine in 23, benzodiazepines in 4, and smaller numbers involving other substances (including carfentanil and fluorofentanyl).

Source: NDEWS, <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-286/>

2. Guyana (May 28, 2026) - Alert on MDMA, 3,4-methylenedioxymethamphetamine, and Tetrahydrocannabinol (THC)

Guyana’s Early Warning System and the Customs Anti Narcotics Unit (CANU), with technical support from the Guyana Drug Information Network (GUYDIN) and the National Early Warning System (EWS), issued a level 3 public health alert regarding the distribution of synthetic drugs targeting school-aged children.

Neon-colored orange and green synthetic products marked as “sweets,” “molly,” “ecstasy,” and handmade cannabis spliffs known as “Power Puff,” were reportedly circulating among secondary school students in Georgetown and other nearby communities, often in small plastic bags. The preliminary findings indicated suspected exposure to 3,4-methylenedioxymethamphetamine (MDMA) and Tetrahydrocannabinol (THC). However, investigators warn that substances may also contain unknown synthetic adulterants capable of causing severe psychological and physiological effects.

The alert urges parents, schools, and healthcare providers to address this issue as a serious public health concern by increasing awareness of synthetic drugs and vaping culture, and strengthening supervision of adolescents.

Source: Customs Anti-Narcotics Unit, <https://canu.gov.gy/ews/>

3. Colombia (May 27, 2026) – Alert on “tuci”

Colombia’s Early Warning System conducts permanent monitoring of “tuci” through the analysis of street samples, in response to the increased distribution and use in Medellin, Antioquia. Sample results indicate that “tuci” is not composed of a single substance, but rather variable combinations of multiple synthetic psychoactive substances, adulterants and cutting agents.

The most common components include MDMA, MDA, methamphetamine, ketamine, acetaminophen, and caffeine. Other substances found include paramethoxymethamphetamine (PMMA), oxycodone, tramadol, clonazepam, cocaine, and synthetic cathinones. Veterinary substances and adulterants, including xylazine and levamisole, were also reported, along with phenacetin, fluoxetine, pregabalin, lidocaine, and aminopyrine.

The composition of “tuci” depends largely on how it is prepared and by whom. One analyzed sample contained more than nine different substances, underscoring the unpredictable composition of “tuci” and the associated health risks posed by complex drug mixtures.

The Ministry of Justice called on healthcare providers to strengthen prevention measures, epidemiological surveillance, and patient follow-up.

Source: Ministry of Justice, Colombia’s Early Warning System, <https://www.minjusticia.gov.co/programas-co/ODC/Paginas/SAT.aspx>

4. Guyana (May 24, 2026) - Alert on THCP Novel cannabinoid-infused gummies

Guyana’s EWS reported new cases involving the circulation of synthetic drugs in secondary schools, emphasizing growing concerns about the targeting of youth in educational settings. These substances are reportedly being labeled as “safe” and “fun” sweets, creating a dangerous false perception of safety and potentially contributing to increased use.

Medical toxicology screening confirmed exposure to methamphetamine, amphetamine, and tetrahydrocannabiphorol (THCP). THCP is an emerging cannabinoid reported to have

substantially greater binding affinity for cannabinoid receptors than delta-9 THC, raising concerns about its potential psychoactive effects.

Investigators highlighted the use of peer pressure to engage more minors in polysubstance use. The report warned parents about the role of social media in promoting these substances among students. It provides guidance for law enforcement and educational institutions, encouraging them to strengthen confidential reporting mechanisms and improve the collection and sharing of information on emerging drug trafficking trends in schools.

Source: Customs Anti Narcotic Unit, <https://canu.gov.gy/ews/>

5. United States (May 22, 2026) – Alert on Medetomidine

The NDEWS Weekly Report highlighted 182 nonfatal overdose cases involving medetomidine, also known as “rhino tranq” between 2023 and 2026, underscoring the presence of adulterants in the unregulated opioid supply. Medetomidine is a veterinary sedative that has increasingly been identified in combination with fentanyl and heroin.

Demographic data indicated that 62.7% of cases involved White individuals and 10.4% involved Black individuals, with additional cases reported among other racial and ethnic groups. By age and sex, men aged 40-49 accounted for the largest share of cases, representing more than 20%, while women in the same age group represented less than 15%. Men and women aged 30-39 accounted for approximately 16% of cases, while individuals aged 20-29 represented slightly more than 5%. No adolescent cases were reported. The alert also noted important data limitations, including the possibility of underreporting, overreporting, or case misclassification.

The report warns that people may be exposed to medetomidine unknowingly when using other substances. Cases of severe withdrawal symptoms have been recorded in connection with medetomidine exposure.

Source: NDEWS, <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-285/>

6. United States (May 15, 2026) – Alert on Mitragynine Derivatives & Kratom Byproducts

The NDEWS Weekly Report warns of kratom-related alkaloids and derivatives, including Mitragynine, Mitragynine pseudoindoxyl (MP), concentrated 7-hydroxymitragynine (7-OH), and semi-synthetic analogs like dihydro-7-hydroxymitragynine (MGM-15).

These compounds are increasingly available for purchase on online platforms and physical stores without adequate labeling regarding chemical composition, intended use, or pharmacological properties. The concern reflects a rapidly evolving synthetic drug market

in which minor chemical modifications can generate new variations of largely unregulated substances. U.S. monitoring has documented the presence of kratom-related alkaloids and, more recently, an increase in chemically modified derivatives appearing in new products.

Investigators also reported an escalation in 2026 detections of mitragynine-related substances among decedents in the state of Florida, including MP and MGM-15. The report underscores the importance of continued monitoring, timely information-sharing, and public awareness regarding emerging kratom-related compounds.

Source: NDEWS, <https://ndews.org/newsletter/archive/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-284/>

7. Guyana (May 13, 2026) - Alert on Crystal Meth

Guyana's EWS reported a significant public health and security concern regarding an off-white, crystal-like, granular substance suspected to be methamphetamine hydrochloride, commonly known as crystal meth. This highly potent and addictive synthetic stimulant has increased its circulation through airports, postal channels, nightlife settings, and other spaces. The alert linked this trend to regional trafficking and organized crime threats affecting people of different age groups.

Testing results are pending to determine the purity and composition of the substance. Authorities warned of the possibility that crystal meth may be mixed with, or used alongside other synthetic and psychoactive substances, including MDMA/ecstasy, and cocaine, increasing the risk of serious health harms. These may include neurotoxic effects, acute psychiatric symptoms, depression and suicidal ideation, and psychological dependence.

The report calls for increased attention to synthetic drug trafficking patterns, online distribution channels, and the possible circulation of high-risk synthetic stimulants in Guyana.

Source: Customs Anti Narcotic Unit, <https://canu.gov.gy/ews/>

8. Guyana (May 13, 2026) - Alert on MDMA

Guyana's Customs Anti Narcotic Unit (CANU) issued a level two alert confirming the circulation of 3,4-methylenedioxymethamphetamine (MDMA). Following an intelligence operation, CANU officers seized amphetamine-type stimulants (ATS), highlighting the continued danger of tablet-based synthetic drug trafficking within micro-distribution networks.

MDMA is a stimulant and empathogenic psychoactive substance that can alter perception, mood and sensory experience. It is prohibited in Guyana under the Narcotic Drugs and

Psychotropic Substances Control Act, Cap. 10:10. Test results confirm varying concentrations of MDMA, as well as adulteration with caffeine, methamphetamine, synthetic cathinones, and other stimulants.

The alert identified nightlife settings as a key environment for MDMA, particularly among youth at parties and social events, where use may occur alongside alcohol and other substances. The effects of MDMA can last for up to six hours, with some cases lasting longer when additional doses are taken after the effects of the previous dose have begun to decrease. The report also warned of possible after-effects in the days following use, including irritability, sleep disruption, and depressive symptoms.

Source: Customs Anti Narcotic Unit, <https://canu.gov.gy/ews/>

9. Guyana (May 13, 2026) - Alert on THCP Novel cannabinoid-infused gummies

Guyana's CANU confiscated edible psychoactive substances during passenger screening operations at the Cheddi Jagan International Airport (CJIA). The products found in a passenger's baggage were marked as "mushroom gummies" and "entheogenic nootropic blend mushroom gummies." Preliminary testing indicated the presence of cannabinoid and hallucinogenic-type substances, including tetrahydrocannabiphorol (THCP), as well as substances associated with psychoactive mushrooms.

Two products were submitted for forensic examination and further drug investigation to confirm their composition, origin, intended destination, possible supply chain linkages, and the potential circulation of similar substances. The first product, "Wunder Sour Apple Mushroom Gummies," contained the following characteristics: 12,000 MG + 20 MG THCP, packaging references to Lion's mane, reishi, and hemp-derived THCP, and advertising as an "entheogenic mind trip blend." The second one, "Wunder Entheogenic Nootropic Blend Mushroom Gummies-Grape," was labeled as: 1,200 MG High Potency Blend with 150 MG Kava per gummy, and included packaging references to euphoric effects and altered perception. Authorities warned that labeling products as "natural," "plant-based," or "supplements" does not exempt them from regulatory scrutiny or possible legal action.

Source: Customs Anti Narcotics Unit, <https://canu.gov.gy/ews/>

